Example product brief

Problem, users, one metric, what is out of scope. Project: the savings simulation.

Sector: Product management, fintech onboarding

Status: concept study, written and designed by Karthik Bindumon, 2026. Numbers are targets or modelled assumptions and are labelled as such.

Method: The Realisation Loop, v1 (see 00-realisation-loop.pdf).

1 Problem

First-job earners in India receive financial literacy as content: articles, videos, a chart of compounding. The content is read and nothing changes in the bank account. The partner's onboarding funnel loses most users between account creation and a first standing instruction.

2 Users

Salaried, 21 to 26, first two years of work, monthly family transfer common, at least one EMI. Phone-first, six minutes of attention, allergic to a product pitch. Secondary user: the partner's growth team, who need one verified behaviour to report.

3 Goal and non-goals

Goal. Move the auto-transfer rate at 90 days for users who complete the toy, against users who read the article.

Non-goals. Teaching financial concepts. Selling any product inside the turns. Daily engagement. Social features. A leaderboard of any kind (refused on principle: money plus ranking equals shame).

4 Success metric

One metric per release. Release 1: verified payday auto-transfer within 90 days of the reveal, toy cohort against article cohort, target 25 percent against the article baseline. Guardrail: no rise in support tickets tagged 'pressure' or 'misleading'.

5 Scope, release 1

Feature	In or out	Why
Twelve-turn script, three actions each	In	The product.
Counterfactual reveal at month 36	In	The mechanic; nothing works without it.
One-tap auto-transfer with partner deep link	In	The single action the metric measures.

Feature	In or out	Why
Share your result card	Out, release 2	Serves reach, not the metric.
Daily reminder push	Out	Serves retention, not the metric; adds pressure.
Leaderboard among friends	Never	Conflicts with the refusal list.

6 Risks

Risk	Mitigation
Reveal reads as a guilt trip	Tone test with eight users before launch; copy never uses 'should'.
Partner wants product placement in turns	Contract line agreed before design starts; no placement inside turns.
Assumed 12 percent return read as a promise	Disclaimer on the reveal screen in the same type size as the numbers.
Deep link unavailable on some banks	Fallback: a one-line instruction and a copy button for the standing-instruction form.

7 Plan

Week 1 to 2: script and arithmetic model, eight user interviews. Week 3 to 4: build in the partner's onboarding shell, tone test. Week 5: A/B live, 2,000 per arm. Week 6 to 18: read the 90-day number weekly, in writing, one owner. Decision at week 18: scale, iterate, or kill with a post-mortem.

8 Open questions

Which bank events count as 'verified'? Does the family-transfer turn need a regional variant? What is the article baseline today?